

Fangzheng Ding

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Education

- 09.2026 - Ongoing **Medicine, MB and BChir**
Gonville and Caius College, University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK.
- 09.2023 - 07.2026 **BA in Natural Sciences (Pharmacology)**
Gonville and Caius College, University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK.
- 09.2021 - 07.2023 **A-levels: 4A*s in Maths, Biology, Chemistry, Physics**
The Manchester Grammar School, Manchester, UK
- 09.2019 - 07.2021 **GCSEs: 9s in 11 subjects (including Maths, Sciences, and English)**
The Manchester Grammar School, Manchester, UK

Awards and Achievements

- 2025 **Summer Vacation Studentship Award (2025)**
Granted to support research into Nav1.5/ β -blockers at the Jackson Lab
- 2021 - 2023 **Gold Medals in Cambridge Chemistry Challenge (L6), and Intermediate Maths Olympiad; Gold in British Biology Olympiad; British Maths Olympiad Round 1 Qualifier**

Research Experience

- 01.2025 - 02.2025 **Laboratory Shadowing Padamsey Lab, Institute of Metabolic Science, University of Cambridge**
Exposure to primary neuronal cell culture and whole cell patch clamp electrophysiology
- 06.2025 - 10.2025 **Investigation towards the inhibition of Nav1.5 by β -blockers (12 Week Project)**
Jackson Lab, Department of Biochemistry, University of Cambridge
Developed research skills in HEK cell culture and automated patch clamp to investigate the electrophysiological effects of β -blockers on Nav1.5. Developed a Python script for automating the analysis of electrophysiological data, and presented at lab meetings.
- 01.2026 - 03.2026 **Identification of a sub-population of glucose-sensitive RXFP4-positive hypothalamic neurons (8 Week Project - Part II)**
Gribble-Reimann Lab, Institute of Metabolic Science, University of Cambridge
Immunohistochemistry to utilise cFos as a marker of neuronal activation Preparation and carrying out of ex vivo calcium imaging of live brain slices to investigate effects of varying glucose concentrations on this sub-population.

Research Skills

Electrophysiology and Imaging	Automated whole cell patch clamp recording, ex vivo calcium imaging of live brain slices, introduction to manual patch clamp
Molecular and Cell Biology	Primary neuronal culture, HEK cell culture, immunohistochemistry, affinity chromatography, western blot, ELISA, PCR
Computational and Data Analysis	Foundations in Python, LaTeX, Dart/Flutter, and HTML.

Community and Outreach

2024 - 2025	The Asthma Project Workshops on public speaking and asthma culminating in presenting to a class of primary school children
2022 - 2023	L'Arche Manchester Volunteered at a care home for members of the community with severe learning disabilities
	Coding Club Started and led the coding club for a local primary school, taught Year 5/6 students to code Scratch and Python for Micro:Bit

Society Responsibilities

Current	Vice-President and Co-Founder for Cambridge University Pharmacology Society Supported the president in building the society and managing its operations.
Former	Treasurer and co-founder for Gonville and Caius Table Tennis Society Responsible for the initial founding of the club and tracking its finances. Secretary for Cambridge University Alternative Music Society Monitored and responded to enquiries and wrote a weekly newsletter. President for Manchester Grammar School Medical Society Mentored prospective medical students, and organised external speakers Outreach Officer for Manchester Grammar School Involved in starting and participating in volunteering opportunities

Research Publications

Hamaia, S., **Ding, F.**, Huang, C., Brackenbury, W., Jackson, A., & Salvage, S. (2025, September). Development and validation of human fragment antibodies to the neonatal variant of the cardiac sodium channel (nNa_v1.5). Poster presented (by S. Hamaia) at 34th Ion Channels Meeting. Sète, France.

Interests

Grade 8 Piano | Grade 5 Music Theory | Table Tennis | Creative Writing

References

References are available upon request.